TECHNIQUES OF PROPAGANDA

Holsti lists several techniques of conducting propaganda with the ultimate aim to deliver the specific message to the targeted group. These techniques are now enumerated.

Name Calling: It is the attaching of an emotion-laden symbol to a person or country, for instance, calling the Soviet Union as the "evil empire" during the Cold War days, or the "axis of evil" (used by president George Bush) for Libya, Iraq and North Korea after the Cold War, or naming the communists as "Reds" or constitutional governments as "capitalist cliques".

Glittering Generality: It is similar to the previous one but aimed at describing a policy rather than an individual, for example, "free world" used by the Western propagandists, or "Socialist solidarity" used by the communists.

Transfer: It means identifying an idea, person, country or policy with some other in order to make the target approve or disapprove it, for instance, evoking hostility among religious people against communism is equating it with atheism.

Plain Folks: It is to do away with the image as foreigner propagandists appear to identify themselves as closely as possible with the values and lifestyle of the targets using local slang, accent and idiom.

Testimonial: It means using an esteemed person or institution to endorse or criticize an idea or a political entity.

Selection: It refers to the selection of facts, although seldom, specific in factual content. Propagandists tend to use those facts only which are required to prove predetermined objectives.

Bandwagon: This technique plays on the audience's desire to belong to or be in accord with the crowd. Similar to the testimonial, but rather a mass of people and not a single esteemed person or institution, serves as the attraction. The messages of the communist propagandists used such phrases as "the whole world knows that…," "all peace-loving people recognize that…" and others.

Frustration Scapegoat: It means releasing frustration by creating a